Yet World War II was the last major war where command of the ocean, whether the high or inner seas, was a strategic necessity. In the post–World War II era, the United States dominated the oceans and most of the skies, except over the Soviet bloc. The new era required a new geopolitical concept, and Spykman's thesis was modified by the Harvard political scientist Samuel Huntington. Prior Eurasian struggles for mastery had taken place among Eurasian powers. Now, with the balance of global military might held by a nation in a different hemisphere, how could the idea of maintaining geopolitical control fit traditional models?

Huntington provided an answer in his well-known 1954 article in the US Naval Institute's *Proceedings*. "National Policy and the Transoceanic Navy" recapped the eras of US naval strategy and argued that in the modern era the power of the US Navy would be employed over transoceanic range but for the same goals.[17] Huntington presciently saw that naval power in the post–World War II era would be used almost solely for effecting land-based struggles in the rimland (and he could have made the same argument about the US Air Force). Huntington's insight helped explain MacArthur's landing at Inchon in 1950, US carrier-based air operations against North Vietnam, the air and amphibious operations of the 1991 Gulf War, and the Iraq War two decades later. No longer was naval power concerned with command of the sea, since the United States held it uncontested, except perhaps in the submarine race with the Soviets during the Cold War. Transcontinental air power also removed limitations on US bombers, though tactical fighters were still employed to defend the "marginal skies" of the American homeland, just as the Soviets planned to counter the US Air Force over the inner skies of Europe. While the geostrategic chessboard had expanded, the military objectives were little altered.

III.

Today America has lost a conscious understanding of the strategic importance of the inner seas and skies, at a moment when it faces the